WEB STANDARDS AND COMPLIANCE

WyIT - 1004

PURPOSE: To define Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) accessibility requirements for agency websites and non-mapping web applications; conditions for using links to vendors, private sector businesses, and other non-government entities; applicable settings within State websites; supported technologies for deploying agency websites and web applications; and the conditions for use of audio, video, and image file types in agency websites.

I. APPLICABILITY

This policy applies to all Executive Branch agencies, boards, and commissions staff (collectively referred to as “agencies”). This policy is also applicable to consultants, affiliates, and temporary employees.

II. DEFINITIONS

All definitions for this policy are located in the Policy Dictionary.

III. EXCEPTIONS

Any exceptions provided to the following policy must abide by WyIT - 3002 - Security Exception Request policy.

IV. ADA COMPLIANCE

Provide reasonable steps to accommodate ADA compliance for all websites and web applications. Accommodations should always be taken to provide website and web application content in an alternate accessible format in the event ADA requirements cannot be met.

V. ADVERTISING LINKS

A. Allowable Uses of Commercial Links

- The link is required under a software license or copyright agreement, and the software is an integral part of the website and/or web application.
- When an organization has a defined ongoing business or a functional relationship with the State entity and that requires a link.
- The citizens of Wyoming would see direct value from the link. This does not include temporary business partnerships such as professional services contracts.
- The link is for a specific product or technology required to access data or functionality on the website or web application, for example, Adobe Acrobat Reader.
- The link provides site security information to validate Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) Certificates from the certificate provider.
- Links to city, county, or federal websites.

B. Required Disclaimer

- “By using this website, you acknowledge that the State of Wyoming does not endorse any of the sites or services that may be referenced on or linked to on this site. The State of Wyoming will not be responsible or liable for those sites' content or any loss occasioned by any such content. Other Internet sites or services may have privacy policies or security that differ from the privacy policy or security of the State of Wyoming.”

VI. PUBLIC FACING STATE WEBSITES

A. Requirements

- Citizen Information,
- Business Information,
- Government Information,
- Visitor Information, and
- Wyoming Attorney General’s Privacy Policy.

VII. WEBSITE & WEB APPLICATION REQUIREMENTS

All websites and web applications must at a minimum be World Wide Web Consortium (W3C) , http://www.w3.org/standards/, compliant as a requirement for rendering web pages in a variety of web browsers.

VIII. WEB TRANSPORT LAYER (TLS) SECURITY CERTIFICATES

A. Any web site or web application that requires authentication through the use of user IDs, passwords, pin numbers, etc. must use TLS encryption on the pages utilizing authentication.

B. Any sensitive data transmitted over the internet must use TLS. Sensitive information may include:

- Social Security Number, Employer Identification Number, or other account identifiers; or
- Date of birth; or
- Phone number for a person or business; or
- Street address for a person or business; or
- Employment and wage information; or
- Health information; or
- Other information defined by law as confidential, sensitive, or non-public information

C. At a minimum, web pages providing user authentication using TLS must display the certificate vendor's secure site seal on the login page.

D. Only valid third-party TLS certificates can be used on public access pages that require TLS.

E. Intranet pages that require TLS can use either third-party TLS certificates, or internally generated certificates.

F. Must use current and non-deprecated encryption algorithms to ensure robust security and protect against known vulnerabilities.

IX. WEB DOMAIN NAMING

A. All new state agency internet and intranet websites must use wyo.gov as the URL suffix if they are supported on the state's primary Domain Name Server (DNS).

B. Existing state agency internet and intranet websites can still use one of the following suffixes:

- wyo.gov ➜ e.g. ets.wyo.gov
- wy.gov ➜ e.g. dot.wy.gov
- wyoming.gov ➜ e.g. doe.wyoming.gov
- wyoming.us ➜ e.g. dfs.wyoming.us
- state.wy.us ➜ e.g. gf.state.wy.us
- .edu ➜ e.g. wy.edu. Wcc.edu

C. The suffixes below are acceptable for public state agency websites, but will not be supported in the state's primary Domain Name Server (DNS). It is the responsibility of the state agency to either manage their own DNS to support these suffixes or have the domain names supported outside the state's DNS server.

- .org

D. A website developed and hosted outside the State of Wyoming infrastructure can be moved into the State of Wyoming infrastructure using a supported domain name suffix.

X. WEB COOKIE USE

A. A visitor to a state web site should not be required to accept a cookie in order to view public information.

B. The use of persistent cookies should be avoided. If used, they should contain a unique name identifying the site or application.

C. Cookies must not store confidential information unless they are encrypted.

REFERENCES

- Wyoming §§ 40-21-101 — 40-21-119
- IRS Publication 1075, Safeguards for Protecting Federal Tax Returns and Return Information
- Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA)

- Minimum Acceptable Risk Standards for Exchanges (MARS-E) 2.0 Framework
- Family Education Rights Privacy Act (FERPA)
- Payment Card Industry – Data Security Standards (PCI-DSS)
- Criminal Justice Information Services (CJIS)
- Children's Online Privacy Protection Act (COPPA)

SUPERSEDED POLICIES: This policy supersedes the policies listed below.

- 03300-P010, Web Domain Naming Policy, dated September 27, 2016
- 03500-P013, Web Cookie Use Policy, dated May 20, 2016

DOCUMENT HISTORY

ORIGINAL SUBMISSION				
SUBMITTED ON	**SUBMITTED BY**	**APPROVED BY**	**APPROVED BY DATE(S)**	**EFFECTIVE DATE**
June 2024	ETS Governance, Risk and Compliance	Public Comment Period	06/14/2024 - 06/28/2024	July 2024

REVISIONS				
REVISION DATE	**REVISED BY**	**APPROVED BY**	**APPROVED BY DATE(S)**	**EFFECTIVE DATE**
November 2024	ETS Governance, Risk and Compliance	State Chief Information Officer	September 2016 May 2016 (See 'Superseded Policy Above)	November 2024

REVIEWS		
REVIEW DATE	**LAST REVIEWED BY**	**NEXT REVIEW DATE**